

## Transformation of society: From primitive society to industrial and postindustrial society



### Transformation of society

#### Social transformation:

- Social transformation refers to long-term changes in the structure and organization of society.
- Transformations affect how people work, live, communicate, and interact.
- Throughout history, societies have moved from simple subsistence systems to highly complex technological systems.

#### Major Drivers of Change

- Technological innovation
- Population growth
- Environmental adaptation
- Economic development
- Expansion of trade and communication networks



### Transformation of society

#### Types of societies:

- Societies can be classified based on their historical development and dominant economic system (Lenski & Lenski, 1995).
- When societies modernize they transform from one form to another.
- Lenski and Lenski (1995) classifies societies as follows:
  1. Primitive (Hunting and gathering) societies
  2. Pastoral societies
  3. Horticultural societies
  4. Agricultural societies
  5. Industrial societies and
  6. Post-industrial societies.

### Transformation of society

#### 1. Primitive (Hunting and gathering) societies:

The primitive (hunter-gatherer) society is the earliest form of human society, where people depended on hunting wild animals, fishing, and gathering edible plants for survival.

**Time Period:** 200,000 years ago to 10,000 BCE

#### Key Characteristics:

- Subsistence economy (hunting & gathering)
- Nomadic lifestyle (20–50 people)
- Simple stone, wood, and bone tools
- Egalitarian society with little social inequality
- Kinship-based social organization
- Strong cooperation and resource sharing
- Nature-based (animistic) beliefs

**Examples:** Hadza (Tanzania), San (Southern Africa)



### Transformation of society

#### Major Changes Leading to the Next Stage:

It is believed that environmental changes and the depletion of resources may have prompted the shift to herding of livestock.

#### The key features of changes are as follows:

- Domestication of plants and animals
- Shift from nomadic to sedentary lifestyles.
- Population growth and resource scarcity



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#### 2. Pastoral societies:

The pastoral society is a type of society in which people depend primarily on the domestication and herding of livestock for food, clothing, transport, and livelihood.

**Time Period:** Around 10,000 BCE to the present (in some regions)

#### Key Characteristics:

- Livestock-based economy (cattle, sheep, goats, camels)
- Semi-nomadic or nomadic lifestyle
- Seasonal movement in search of pasture and water
- Wealth and social status measured by livestock ownership
- Trade in meat, milk, wool, hides, and other animal products
- Simple tools and temporary or portable shelters

**Examples:** Bedouins (Middle East), Mongolian Nomads (Mongolia)



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#### Major Changes Leading to the Next Stage:

- Domestication of plants and early crop cultivation
- Use of simple farming tools (hoes and digging sticks)
- Transition to permanent village settlements
- Population growth and a more reliable

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#### 3. Horticultural societies:

The **horticultural society** is a type of society in which people depend primarily on **small-scale farming using simple hand tools** to cultivate crops for subsistence.

**Time Period:** Around 10,000 BCE to the present

##### Key Characteristics:

- Small-scale cultivation of crops
- Use of simple tools (hoes, digging sticks)
- Permanent or semi-permanent villages
- Mixed economy with farming and limited animal domestication
- Family- and community-based labor
- Food surplus supporting population growth

**Examples:** Jarmo (Iraq), Yanomami (Amazon Basin)



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#### Major Changes Leading to the Next Stage:

- Development of the plough and irrigation systems
- Expansion from small-scale to large-scale farming
- Permanent settlements developed into towns and cities
- Food surplus, population growth, and social stratification

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#### 4. Agricultural societies:

The **agricultural (agrarian) society** is a type of society in which people depend primarily on large-scale farming using ploughs, irrigation, and animal power

**Time Period:** ~10,000 BCE – 1750 CE

##### Key Characteristics:

- Large-scale farming and irrigation
- Use of ploughs, animal power, and metal tools
- Permanent villages, towns, and cities
- Food surplus and population growth
- Social classes based on land ownership
- Development of trade, government, and organized religion

**Examples:** Ancient Mesopotamia (Sumerians, Iraq), Indus Valley Civilization (Harappa and Mohenjo-daro), Ancient China (Yellow River Civilization)



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#### Major Changes Leading to the Next Stage:

It is believed that **technological innovations, mechanized production, and population growth** transformed agrarian societies into industrial societies.

##### Major Changes:

- **Industrial Revolution** and invention of machines
- **Mechanization** of agriculture and manufacturing
- **Expansion of market economies** and factory production
- **Rapid urbanization** through migration from rural areas to cities

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#### 5. Industrial societies:

An **industrial society** is one in which goods are produced using machines, factories, and modern technology, replacing manual and animal-powered production.

**Time Period:** Late 18th century – Mid-20th century

##### Key Characteristics:

- Machine-based manufacturing and factory production
- Rapid urbanization and growth of cities
- Capitalist economy and wage labor
- Emergence of industrial social classes (capitalists and workers)
- Technological innovations (steam engine, electricity, railways)
- Expansion of education, science, and communication

**Examples:** Great Britain (Industrial Revolution, 18th century)



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#### Major Changes Leading to the Next Stage:

It is believed that **advances in information technology, globalization, and automation** transformed industrial societies into post-industrial societies.

#### Major Changes

- Rapid development of **information and communication technology (ICT)**
- **Automation** and computerization of industries
- Shift from **manufacturing** to **service- and knowledge-based economies**
- Expansion of **globalization** and interconnected economies

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#### 6. Post-industrial societies:

A **post-industrial society** is one in which the economy is driven primarily by **information, knowledge, technology, and services** rather than manufacturing.

**Time Period:** Late 20th century (1980s) – Present

#### Key Characteristics:

- Service- and knowledge-based economy
- Advanced information and communication technologies (ICT)
- Automation, artificial intelligence (AI), and robotics
- Globalization and digital connectivity
- Highly educated and skilled workforce
- Greater emphasis on innovation and sustainability



**Examples:** United States, Japan, Canada, Germany, and South Korea

### Transformation of society

#### Major Changes Leading to the Next Stage (Future Society):

It is believed that **rapid advances in digital technologies, artificial intelligence, and biotechnology** may transform post-industrial societies into a new stage of societal development.

#### Possible Future Changes

- Advances in **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and biotechnology
- Transition to **green and sustainable economies**
- Greater automation and human-AI collaboration
- Emergence of **AI-integrated or smart societies**

#### Example: Silicon Valley (USA, 1970s–Present)

- Shift from manufacturing to **knowledge-based industries**
- Growth of **IT, AI, biotechnology, and digital innovation**
- Companies such as **Apple, Google, Microsoft, and NVIDIA** have transformed global communication, business, and innovation.

# Thank you all

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